

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can determine the main idea of an informational text and explain how details support it.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

Name the topic, ask what the author teaches about it, then connect each important detail to that idea.

Text: City trees cool sidewalks, clean the air, and give birds shelter. **Main idea:** Trees make cities healthier habitats.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Topic or main idea? 'desert animals'
2. Topic or main idea? 'Desert animals have features that help them survive.'
3. Which is a supporting detail: 'Camels store fat in humps' or 'Animals are interesting'?
4. Explain how a detail must connect to the main idea.

B. CORE PRACTICE - SHOW YOUR WORK

5. Read: Honeybees carry pollen between flowers. This helps many plants make fruits and seeds.

6. Write the main idea of the bee text.

7. List one supporting detail.

8. Explain why 'Bees live on every continent except Antarctica' would be less useful here.

9. Read: Wetlands absorb extra rainwater. Their plants slow moving water, and their soil holds water like a sponge.

10. Write the main idea of the wetlands text.

11. List two supporting details.

12. Choose a heading for the wetlands text.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CALCULATE AND CHECK

13. Write a main-idea sentence for a paragraph about recycling paper.

14. Add one detail that would support it.

15. Cross out the unrelated detail: Paper can be recycled / Tigers have stripes / Recycling saves trees.

16. Complete: A supporting detail matters because ____.

17. State the topic of the wetlands text.

18. State what the author teaches about that topic.

19. Use because to connect the main idea and one detail.

20. Summarize the bee text in one sentence.

Name: _____

Date: _____

D. APPLY THE SKILL

21. Read: Sea otters float in kelp forests. Kelp gives them shelter, and otters protect kelp by eating sea urchins. State the main idea and two supporting details.

22. Which detail best supports the idea that otters help kelp forests? Explain.

23. Write a 2-sentence objective summary of the otter text.

E. REASON, CHECK AND CORRECT

24. Why is a main idea broader than one detail?

25. A student says the wetlands text is mainly about rain. Correct the student using evidence.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Write the main idea of the city-tree example and one supporting detail.

Challenge: Write a four-sentence informational paragraph. Underline the main-idea sentence and circle three supporting details.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

A. 1) topic. 2) main idea. 3) Camels store fat in humps. 4) It must explain or prove the main idea.

B. 5) source text. 6) Bees help plants reproduce by carrying pollen. 7) They carry pollen between flowers / plants make fruits and seeds. 8) It does not explain their role in plant reproduction. 9) source text. 10) Wetlands reduce flooding by holding and slowing water. 11) Plants slow water; soil holds water. 12) How Wetlands Hold Water.

C. 13-14) Answers vary; detail must directly support the stated idea. 15) Tigers have stripes. 16) it explains or proves the main idea. 17) wetlands. 18) Wetlands absorb and slow extra water. 19) Answers vary. 20) Bees help plants make fruits and seeds by carrying pollen.

D. 21) Otters live in and help kelp forests; kelp shelters otters; otters eat urchins that harm kelp. 22) Otters eat sea urchins. 23) Answers vary; include only central ideas.

E. 24) It covers what the whole text teaches. 25) Rain is one detail; all sentences explain how wetlands hold and slow water.

EXIT. 26) Trees make cities healthier habitats; any listed detail.

Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.

F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students often choose an interesting fact as the main idea. Check that the idea covers every important sentence.

TEACHER CHECK

☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 3 ELA strategy.

☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.

☐ Checks a response using evidence, a rule, or a second method.

☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. Have them point to the text evidence or language rule, then revise one response aloud.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.